

# Schedule

## PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

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20 January 2026

### Term 2 Schedule

#### Term Dates

- **Term Start:** Monday 12 January 2026
- **Reading Week:** 16-20 February 2026
- **Term End:** Friday 27 March 2026

### Weekly Overview

| Week | Dates     | Topic                       | Lecture | Lab                     | Assessment |
|------|-----------|-----------------------------|---------|-------------------------|------------|
| 11   | 12-16 Jan | DataLab                     | None    | Data-Lab                |            |
| 12   | 19-23 Jan | Distributions & Variability | Yes     | De-scriptives in R      |            |
| 13   | 26-30 Jan | Building Your Re-search     | Yes     | Re-search Plan Workshop |            |
| 14   | 2-6 Feb   | Is Your Effect Real?        | Yes     | t-tests in R            |            |
| 15   | 9-13 Feb  | Correlation                 | Yes     | Correlation in R        |            |

| Week | Dates     | Topic                        | Lecture         | Lab            | Assessment                          |
|------|-----------|------------------------------|-----------------|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| —    | 16-20 Feb | <b>Reading Week</b>          | —               | —              | Work on Research Plan               |
| 16   | 23-27 Feb | Regression                   | Yes             | Project groups | <b>Research Plan due Fri 27 Feb</b> |
| 17   | 2-6 Mar   | Interpretation & Credibility | Yes             | Project groups |                                     |
| 18   | 9-13 Mar  | MCQ Exam                     | <b>MCQ Exam</b> | Project groups | <b>MCQ Exam Mon 9 Mar</b>           |
| 19   | 16-20 Mar | Project Workshop             | Yes             | Project groups | <b>EDS due Fri 20 Mar</b>           |
| 20   | 23-27 Mar | Wrapping Up                  | Yes             | Report writing |                                     |

## Session Times

| Session     | Day       | Time        | Location |
|-------------|-----------|-------------|----------|
| Lecture     | Wednesday | 10:00-12:00 | RHBD 143 |
| Lab Group A | Thursday  | 10:00-12:00 | WB 304a  |
| Lab Group B | Thursday  | 10:00-12:00 | Wb 304b  |

### Week 11 Note

There is no lecture in Week 11 due to employability events.

## Assessment Deadlines

| Assessment      | Weight | Deadline                             | Week      |
|-----------------|--------|--------------------------------------|-----------|
| Research Plan   | 20%    | Friday 27 February 2026, 12 noon     | 16        |
| MCQ Exam        | 20%    | Monday 9 March 2026, in lecture slot | 18        |
| EDS Assignment  | 20%    | Friday 20 March 2026, 12 noon        | 20        |
| Research Report | 40%    | Friday 1 May 2026, 12 noon           | Post-term |

## **Week-by-Week Detail**

### **First Half: Building Skills (Weeks 11-15)**

#### **Week 11: DataLab**

- Generate the dataset you'll use all term
- Form your project groups
- No lecture

#### **Week 12: Distributions & Variability**

- First lecture (2 hours)
- Mean, median, mode, standard deviation
- Introduction to R for descriptives
- *Report writing: Descriptive statistics*

#### **Week 13: Building Your Research**

- Operationalising variables (with real paper examples)
- Writing hypotheses (one-tailed vs two-tailed)
- Design decisions and trade-offs
- Connecting design to statistical tests
- *Assessment focus: Research Plan preparation*

#### **Week 14: Is Your Effect Real?**

- Null hypothesis significance testing
- p-values and significance
- Confidence intervals and effect sizes (Cohen's d)
- Independent vs paired t-tests
- Complete APA reporting
- *Report writing: t-test results with CIs and effect sizes*

#### **Week 15: Correlation**

- Scatterplots and relationships
- Pearson vs Spearman
- Correlation  $\neq$  causation
- Last week before Reading Week
- *Report writing: Correlation results*

#### **Reading Week**

- Work on your Research Plan (due Week 16)
- Review material for MCQ (Week 18)
- No taught sessions

### **Second Half: Application & Assessment (Weeks 16-20)**

#### **Week 16: Regression**

- **Research Plan due Friday**
- From correlation to prediction
- Line of best fit
- Labs now in project groups
- *Report writing: Methods section*

#### **Week 17: Interpretation & Credibility**

- P-hacking and HARKing
- Replication crisis
- MCQ prep in lecture
- *Report writing: Introduction section*

#### **Week 18: MCQ Exam**

- **MCQ Exam Monday (in lecture slot)**
- Lab is project support
- *Report writing: Introduction continued*

#### **Week 19: Project Workshop**

- APA results reporting
- Project analysis support
- EDS preview
- *Report writing: Discussion preview*

#### **Week 20: Wrapping Up**

- **EDS Assignment due Friday**
- Lecture: Project data showcase, lab report structure, discussion sections
- Lab: Final analysis support and report writing
- *Report writing: Discussion section — interpreting findings, limitations, implications*

### **Key Dates Summary**

|           |                                  |
|-----------|----------------------------------|
| Jan 12-16 | Week 11: DataLab (first contact) |
| Jan 19-23 | Week 12: First lecture           |
| Feb 13    | Last day before Reading Week     |
| Feb 16-20 | Reading Week                     |
| Feb 27    | Research Plan due (noon)         |
| Mar 11    | MCQ Exam (lecture slot)          |
| Mar 20    | EDS Assignment due (noon)        |
| May 1     | Research Report due (noon)       |